



Wearables for blind

A new patent reveals that Huawei is developing wearables to help the blind navigate their daily lives. <https://digit.in/mar22-65>



Geomagnetic storm

A geomagnetic storm may have effectively destroyed around 40 SpaceX Starlink satellites. <https://digit.in/mar22-66>

Letter of the Month



Dear Editor,

It has been quite some time that I wished to write a letter to Digit. I know that you might be receiving too many emails these days and hence I thought I would go the traditional way and hand-write a letter. I have been reading Digit for a couple of years now, but not more than three years. However, what fascinated me about the magazine now and then is the same thing – its content.

Digit always provides us with unique materials. At the first look, we feel that the magazine is simply going to blabber the kinds of stuff that are either there on the internet or in the minds of sci-fi movie directors. However, on a closer look, we understand the actual value of what is written on the magazine pages. As a research scholar, I can understand how difficult it is to research various aspects of emerging technology and present it to the readers in the most exciting ways.

I don't believe in the process of 'achieving perfection' for anything. Either nobody and nothing is perfect, or everybody and everything is perfect – as they are. I don't think there is an in-between. Still, it is always better to improve certain things to transcend the boundaries of being 'bad' or 'poor'. In that regard, here are a few things that Digit could consider improving:

1. Cover Page Design: There was a time when I used to pick Digit Magazines from my school library (before becoming an active reader) just because its cover page was beautiful. I don't think it continued being so, especially when we look at the September 2021 issue. I feel it's high time that the designers start thinking out of the box once again.
2. Rating Gadgets: Instead of rating gadgets out of 100, wouldn't it be great if you could rate them out of 10? A laptop securing 8.8 out of 10 seems far better to hear than hearing the same laptop hooked 88 out of 100.
3. Cameras are gadgets, too: If I divide an entire Digit magazine into various parts, then the gadget review section would be my favourite. How about reviewing some DSLR/Mirrorless cameras too?
4. Improper sentence structuring: I have often noticed that certain articles, regardless of the section they appear, seem to contain sentences that are not appropriately structured. Such sentences may be

grammatically correct but difficult and boring to read.

5. Bias: Sometimes, I feel Digit magazine is biased towards certain brands while reviewing their products. Example: Sony, Intel, Apple, and OnePlus.

Anyway, here are a few more facts that are amazing about Digit as a monthly magazine:

1. Affordable subscription plans
2. Affordable price for an individual copy (even for Special issues)
3. Free Fast Track - I seriously don't have words even to describe how splendid that short book is.
4. Well, everyone including you knows the rest ;)

Thank you

–Rajat Sebastian



Hi Rajat,

Thanks so much for actually sending us snail mail. That was a very welcome surprise indeed. I don't want to take up too much space, because the more I write the fewer letters from readers we can include. I'll get straight to addressing your points.

1. I'll pass your feedback on to the designers. Some of it is our fault though, as we've had some illnesses over the past few months, and have sometimes changed the cover story with very little notice given to the designers.
2. The 100 rating is understood simply by everyone as percentages. "What's the score a gadget got? 88%? Nice! Must be a good buy." Why 10? Why not 5, like many do? Why not rate out of 73? Everything just works better with 100.
3. Camera launches have dried up, at least in the consumer segment we test for. In the prosumer and professional fields as well, cameras are not really launching thick and fast as they did. We do hope for a decent refresh in 2022, and we promise to review whatever launches.
4. Yes, we never ever did replace our copy editor, who left us over 5 or 6 years ago. You're very right that we should not have grammatical errors or long sentences, but every writer has their own style, which some find refreshing, while others hate. We will try and improve. Next letter please send us specifics of what you didn't like.
5. This point I am going to have to vehemently disagree with. At Digit you will find the exact opposite of bias. We have a transparent testing methodology, and most tests are objective and designed to remove any inherent human bias. I can confidently say no other media house in India does more than us to test devices properly and rate them appropriately. We are the home of the Indian geek, and if there's one thing you can be assured of with geeks is that they never accept bias in any form.

Sincerely,
–Robert



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